

RICCARDO DI FRANCESCO

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(This version: *October 2025*)

CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Researcher

Oct. 2024–Present

Principal Investigator: *Seetha Menon*

University of Southern Denmark, Odense

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics and Finance

Sept. 2024

Advisor: *Franco Peracchi*

Co-advisor: *Tommaso Proietti*

Thesis: *“Three Essays in Causal Inference and Machine Learning”*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Visiting Ph.D. Student

Feb.–Dec. 2022

Host: *Michael Lechner*

Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research, St. Gallen

Master of Science in Economics

July 2020

Final Grade: 110/110 *summa cum laude*

Thesis: *“Fleet Competition with Autonomous Vehicles: the Role of Ownership”*

Advisor: *Alberto Iozzi*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Bachelor of Science in Political Economics

Oct. 2018

Final Grade: 107/110

Thesis: *“Macroeconomic Impacts of Brexit”*

Advisor: *Francesco Nucci*

University of Rome La Sapienza, Rome

RESEARCH

Publications

- Di Francesco, R., & Mellace, G. (2025). [Causal inference for qualitative outcomes](#). *Economics Letters*, 112626.
- Di Francesco, R. (2025). [Ordered Correlation Forest](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 44(4), 416–432.

Working Papers

- [Aggregation Trees](#). *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.11408*.
- [The Cost of Coming Out](#) (joint with [Enzo Brox](#)). *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.03649*.

Software

- causalQual: Causal Inference for Qualitative Outcomes. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- valiCATE: Validation of CATE models. ([Website](#))
- ocf: Ordered Correlation Forest. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- aggTrees: Aggregation Trees. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))

REFeree ACTIVITIES

- Social Indicators Research

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Oct. 2023

Paper: *A further look at the gender gap in Italian academic careers*

Authors: Marianna Brunetti, Annalisa Fabretti, Mariangela Zoli

Research Assistant

July 2022

Paper: *Teaching an old dog a new trick: Reserve price and unverifiable quality in repeated procurement*

Authors: Gian Luigi Albano, Berardino Cesi, Alberto Iozzi

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference Reviewer

Jan. 2025

2025 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE)

King's College London, London

Conference Co-organizer and Scientific Committee Member

Sept. 2024

1st Tor Vergata Ph.D. Conference in Economics

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

2025

- 16th International Health Economics Association World Congress (IHEA).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- 38th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE).
- 11th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2024

- CSQIEP Virtual Seminar.
- Rome Conference on Econometrics: Frontiers in Casual Inference.
- 3rd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 29th International Panel Data Conference (IPDC).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Thessaloniki).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Xiamen).
- Annual Conference of the Scottish Economic Society (SES).

2023

- 2nd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 11th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).
- 10th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2022

- 1st Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 10th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Guest Lecturer in Microeconometrics

Oct.–Dec. 2025

Master of Science course, held by Giovanni Mellace

University of Southern Denmark, Odense

Teaching Assistant in Statistics

Feb.–May 2024

Bachelor of Science course, held by Livia De Giovanni

LUISS University, Rome

Teaching Assistant in Applied Statistics and Econometrics*Oct.–Dec. 2023*

Bachelor of Science course, held by Marianna Brunetti

LUISS University, Rome

Teaching Assistant in Statistical Learning*Sept.–Oct. 2021*

Master of Science course, held by Tommaso Proietti

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Econometric Games–Team Captain*Apr. 2023*

Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam

Summer School in Causal Machine Learning*Oct. 2022*

Lecturer: Michael Lechner

University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

Summer School in Theoretical Aspects of Machine Learning*June 2022*

Lecturer: Petyo Bonev

University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

Summer School in Econometrics of Big Data*June 2022*

Lecturers: Christian Hansen, Martin Spindler

University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen

Econometric Games–Team Captain*Apr. 2022*

Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam

Summer School in Semiparametric Learning*July 2021*

Lecturer: Yanyuan Ma

University of Trento, Trento

Summer School in Microeconometrics and Machine Learning for Policy Evaluation*June 2021*

Lecturers: David Margolis, Philipp Ketz, Margherita Comola

Paris School of Economics, Paris

Econometric Games–Team Member*Apr. 2021*

Selected as a member of the University of Rome Tor Vergata team

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam